contribution promises to cut costs by half when exporting data from data centres, clouds, and edge locations to a telemetry platform, a significant leap forward in making telemetry more cost-effective.

Laurent Quérel, project lead and distinguished engineer at F5, emphasised the importance of this advancement, stating, "Modern networking solutions, applications, and users generate unfathomably large volumes of data in the course of everyday operations, making compression rates essential to bringing the benefits of comprehensive telemetry to more organisations in a cost-effective manner."

One of the primary benefits of this innovation is the reduction of egress costs related to telemetry traffic by 50%. Organisations that export telemetry data from public clouds to a telemetry aggregation system using this new OpenTelemetry Protocol refinement can expect substantial cost savings.

F5 has also initiated a partnership with ServiceNow Cloud Observability to introduce the OpenTelemetry Arrow Project and reference implementation guidance. This project leverages Apache Arrow, an open source technology used to provide standardised representations of data, to enhance telemetry capabilities further.

Biden administration takes action to bolster open source software security

In a move to bolster cybersecurity defences and prevent future vulnerabilities in open source software, the White House has called for stronger security measures. A two-day summit, held in September this year, convened technology companies, banks, and industry groups. It underscored the Biden administration's commitment to enhancing security standards in the realm of open source software development.

Anne Neuberger, deputy national security adviser for cyber and emerging technology, emphasised the administration's focus on expanding the use of software bill of materials (SBOMs) among companies. SBOMs provide detailed lists of components within a product or program, aiding in vulnerability assessment and remediation.

The summit, held in Washington, D.C., followed a similar meeting at the White House in January 2022, prompted by the disclosure of a critical vulnerability in Log4j, a widely used open source program tracking network activity. The severity of the Log4j vulnerability prompted immediate action over the holiday season to patch the flaw, leaving cybersecurity experts deeply concerned.

Progress has been made since the last summit, including the development of digital certificates for software by the Open Source Security Foundation. These certificates now cover over 17,000 projects, significantly reducing the risk of malicious additions like ransomware and network backdoors infiltrating open source programs.

Omkhar Arasaratnam, general manager of OpenSSF, which hosted the summit, noted, "What we've seen from both the [strategy], as well as the CISA open source roadmap, is that the government is not just declaring outward, 'thou shalt', but it's also taking its own direction and saying in the federal government, 'we shall'."

Microsoft integrates Python's strength with Excel's versatility

Microsoft has announced the public preview of Microsoft Excel's newest feature: the integration of Python directly within Excel. Available to members of the Microsoft 365 Insiders program through Excel for Windows' Beta Channel, this enhancement is set to revolutionise how data professionals interact with Excel.

The integration of Python into Excel presents a transformative approach to data analytics. With the introduction of the PY function, users can now directly input Python code into Excel. This enhances Excel's capabilities and allows users to delve deeper into advanced data visualisations, machine learning, and data cleaning by leveraging Python's extensive libraries. The backing of Anaconda, a prominent enterprise Python repository, further amplifies this integration. As Python in Excel utilises the Anaconda Distribution in Azure, users are provided access to many Python libraries, a move celebrated by Anaconda's CEO, Peter Wang, as a game-changer for Excel users globally.

Prioritising security, all Python operations within Excel are executed on the secure Microsoft Cloud, with the code running in Azure Container Instances, ensuring the utmost user privacy. Collaboration has also been enhanced; teams can share and work on Python-integrated Excel workbooks effortlessly without requiring additional tools.

This initiative, a product of collaboration across various Microsoft teams, symbolises Microsoft's unwavering commitment to the Python community.

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